STOP PREDICTING. START MANIPULATING.

HYPERSTITIONS
@hyperstiti0ns · Nov 28, 2025

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There's a fundamental tension at the heart of prediction markets. They're designed to aggregate information about what will happen, but what if the act of betting itself could change the outcome? **This reflexive quality - where observation influences reality - has always been treated as a bug to be minimized.**

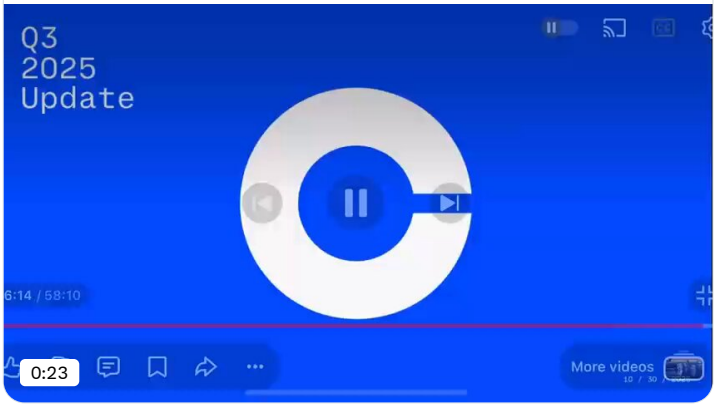
Hasu ⚡🤖 @hasufl · Oct 31, 2025

Not sure if Brian thought he is helping anyone here but the opposite feels true. The subjects of a bet becoming self aware and actively changing their behavior is ironically the failure mode of prediction markets that will lead to liquidity drying up.

Tyrael @0xTyrael · Oct 31, 2025

At the end of the Coinbase earnings call today, Brian Armstrong pulled up the mention market and rattled off all the words that weren't said yet

What a wild time to be alive



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Hyperstition markets flip this entirely: r**eflexivity becomes the core feature, weaponized to manipulate the future.**

From Prediction to Manifestation

A prediction market asks: "What will happen?" Participants bet on outcomes, prices converge toward probabilities, and the market becomes an information aggregation machine. Polymarket showed this during the 2024 election, where market odds became more trusted than polls. But notice what's missing ? The bettors themselves aren't doing anything to influence the outcome. **They're passive observers placing wagers on events beyond their control.**

An hyperstition market asks a different question: "What can we make happen?" The term comes from the CCRU and Nick Land's work in the 1990s, describing fictions that bootstrap themselves into reality through belief and collective action.

> **A hyperstition isn't a prediction, it's a self-fulfilling prophecy with intentional design.**

Consider the difference in practice. When Polymarket ran its Solomon MetaDAO prediction market on how much commitment the sale would get, traders bet based on their assessment of market conditions and community interest. In a hyperstition market on the same question, traders wouldn't just bet, they'd coordinate to make it happen. Buying YES means rallying the community on social media, creating threads explaining why the sale matters, directly encouraging others to commit capital, and building momentum through collective action. **The market becomes a coordination mechanism rather than an observation tool.**

The Futarchy Connection

Hyperstition markets draw heavily from futarchy, the governance framework Robin Hanson proposed in 2000.

Futarchy suggests that organizations should "vote on values, bet on beliefs", using prediction markets to determine which policies will best achieve democratically chosen goals. @MetaDAOProject on Solana has implemented this, letting token holders speculate on which proposals will increase token value.

But traditional futarchy has a limitation: it aggregates information about outcomes without coordinating action toward them.

> You might bet that "launching feature X will increase revenue," but your bet doesn't actually help build feature X. The market reveals what people think will work, but participants remain spectators.

Hyperstition markets complete the circuit. They're futarchy with execution built in. When you bet YES on an outcome, you're not just expressing a belief, you're joining a coordination game where your capital and effort align toward manifestation. The market doesn't just predict which path is better; it mobilizes participants to walk that path together.

Learning from Opportunity Markets

Recent work on Opportunity Markets from @Paradigm / @_Dave__White_ / @no_____end introduced another key innovation: subsidized prediction markets where sponsors provide liquidity to discover information before competitors. A venture fund might create private markets on potential investments, seeding them with capital that informed scouts can win by betting correctly. The sponsor learns from price movements without revealing their interest to the market.

Hyperstition markets borrow the subsidy mechanism but invert the privacy. Where Opportunity Markets keep prices hidden to prevent free-riding, hyperstition markets make everything public precisely because visibility enables coordination. When participants can see momentum building, when they can watch YES prices rise as coordination intensifies, reflexivity emerges naturally.

> Public prices become Schelling points around which collective action organizes.

The subsidy itself serves a different purpose too. In Opportunity Markets, sponsors provide liquidity to extract information. In hyperstition markets, protocols seed one side of the bet to make coordination profitable. By starting with asymmetric odds - heavy on NO, light on YES - the market creates an arbitrage opportunity: if you can coordinate enough participants to manifest the outcome, the returns justify the effort.

The Mechanics of Manifestation

How does this work in practice? A hyperstition market operates through cycles, defined time periods where participants bet on whether a target will be reached. The protocol seeds the NO side heavily, making YES bets cheap but risky. Participants who believe the outcome is achievable buy YES, but buying YES alone doesn't move reality. The key insight is that participants must also take actions that push toward the outcome.

In a market targeting a protocol's TVL growth, betting YES while also providing liquidity creates alignment. Your capital commitment raises the probability your bet pays off. In a market targeting a product launch, betting YES while contributing development work does the same. The market becomes a mechanism for discovering who's willing to coordinate and at what price.

> Traditional incentive programs fail because they’re static. A protocol offers X tokens for Y behavior, but they’re guessing at the exchange rate between capital and coordination. Hyperstitional Cycles solve this through **dynamic price discovery for incentives.**

Each cycle generates data about the true cost of coordination. If a target proves too ambitious, the market reveals this through failure - and subsequent cycles adjust. If subsidies prove excessive, successful outcomes at lower cost inform future parameters. **Over time, organizations discover minimum viable subsidies and maximum achievable targets through iteration rather than guesswork.**

Beyond Speculation

The implications extend well beyond token prices. Any measurable outcome becomes a potential coordination target. DAOs can create markets around shipping features, achieving mindshare metrics, completing security audits, or reaching growth milestones. Research organizations can coordinate around study outcomes. Infrastructure projects can align contributors toward deployment targets.

> This is **incentive price discovery.**

What makes this different from traditional bounties or grants? Price discovery. When an organization sets a bounty, they're guessing at the exchange rate between capital and coordination. They might overpay for easy outcomes or underpay for valuable ones. **Hyperstition markets let the**

market itself discover these prices through competitive dynamics. The result is more efficient allocation of coordination capital.

There's something philosophically significant here too. Prediction markets assume reality is fixed and our job is to perceive it accurately.

> Hyperstition markets assume reality is malleable and our job is to shape it intentionally. This isn't mysticism, it's recognition that many outcomes in complex systems depend on coordination, and coordination depends on shared belief in possibility.

What Comes Next

Hyperstitions launches next week, beginning with a bootstrapping phase that uses token price as the coordination target before expanding to broader applications.

Prediction markets may turn out to have been a stepping stone toward something more powerful: **markets that don't just aggregate information about the future, but actively construct it.**

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